

THE PROJECTOR 2: THE LULLABY

TSU Film 8 — Release Phase 2, Film 2 — the "Thor: The Dark World" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: THE PROJECTOR, a second time — still Tyrese Avery's, still co-run with Jamal Kester per the settlement in `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md`, stable enough now that Tyrese has the standing to be offered something much bigger than a platform.

Why a second THE PROJECTOR fits the Thor: The Dark World slot exactly: The Dark World's shape is grief arriving mid-stability, an old ideology nobody actually killed the first time, an uneasy alliance with a trickster figure, and a throne turned down for something truer. Vernon Price — a content-farm operator predating THE PROJECTOR's entire "creator-first" premise — was never defeated in Film 4, just marginalized by a better idea. That's a villain built to return. And Tyrese, four years past his own humbling, is exactly stable enough now to be offered a throne worth turning down.

Who this film belongs to: Tyrese Avery, with Jamal Kester and Dr. Simone Kester as full partners rather than supporting cast. **Marcus Thien Nguyen-Brandt** — TSU's fixer, dormant in `TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md` since his introduction — fills the Loki position here: not a villain, not fully trustworthy, someone Tyrese needs and shouldn't fully believe, who ends up doing something genuinely costly to help him anyway. Tyrese's mother, **Coralee Avery**, fills the Frigga position. Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smiley's wedding and Amond Baker and Harmony Divine's long-delayed "together" moment — both locked since `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §4 and never yet dramatized on-screen — happen inside this film, as the ensemble's celebration running directly alongside Tyrese's grief.

In-universe timeline: February 2013 – August 2013. Ages verified against `TSU_Core_Cast.md`: Tyrese is 31 the entire film (turned 31 July 24, 2012, before the story opens); Marc-Anthony and Esther are 31; Amond turns 31 Feb 10; Harmony turns 31 June 19. This is the first film to dramatize the wedding date locked since the franchise's earliest canon ("married 2013") and the year Amond and Harmony's "together 2013" finally happens on-screen rather than staying implied.

LOGLINE

Four years after learning the hard way that fame isn't the same thing as being qualified, Tyrese Avery gets offered the chair of a new industry-wide "family-safe content" consortium — the same year his mother dies, his best friends finally marry, and the man whose approach to video he thought his own platform had made obsolete comes back with something built to be soothing on the outside and impossible to look away from underneath.

SYNOPSIS

It's 2013. THE PROJECTOR is thriving — Jamal Kester running product with real authority, Tyrese more hands-on than famous these days, and an industry that finally, grudgingly, respects what they rebuilt.

That respect is exactly what gets Tyrese offered the chair of a new cross-platform **Family-Safe Content Consortium** — a real, prestigious, industry-defining role, the closest thing this franchise has offered anyone to an actual throne.

Before he has to answer, **Vernon Price** resurfaces. He ran the exact kind of algorithm-gaming content farm THE PROJECTOR's "creator-first" launch made obsolete back in Film 4 — not defeated, per his own bible entry, just pushed to less regulated corners of the internet, where he spent years refining an AI-content-generation operation. His new product, **THE LULLABY**, generates infinite, algorithmically-optimized "children's content" — soothing colors, gentle music, marketed as the safest thing a tired parent could put in front of a toddler — engineered underneath, frame by frame, for maximum addictive engagement regardless of what a screen like that actually does to a small child's attention and sleep.

The timing is deliberate. The Family-Safe Content Consortium Tyrese has been offered to chair is mid-rollout on a "kid-safe certified" labeling standard, and for one narrow window — while the certification process is still manual, still trusting, still new — THE LULLABY can get itself certified before anyone examines its actual engagement mechanics closely. Backed a second time by **Maxwell Sterling Asante's** money (a man who has never once stopped chasing the next flashy pitch, regardless of what the last one cost him), Vernon doesn't need to win publicly. He just needs the label.

Tyrese, out of his depth in exactly the way a viral discovery-feed problem never made him feel, is pushed toward **Marcus Nguyen-Brandt** — brought in by the Consortium's board to keep the certification rollout from becoming a scandal before it launches. Marcus's instincts are everything THE PROJECTOR was rebuilt to refuse: manage the story, not the harm. Tyrese hates needing him. He needs him anyway.

In June, in the middle of all of it, **Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smiley** marry — small, real, the whole ensemble together for a genuinely happy reason — and **Amond Baker and Harmony Divine**, circling each other since before any of these companies existed, finally stop circling, at the reception, in the one unguarded moment either of them allows themselves all decade. It's the lightest the franchise has been in eight films, for about six weeks.

Then **Coralee Avery** — the choir director who spent thirty years shaping other people's children, watching a news segment on THE LULLABY's early complaints from worried parents — has a stroke, mid-sentence, telling Reverend Earl how much a technology like that terrifies her for reasons that have nothing to do with her famous son's company and everything to do with three decades of kids she loved. She doesn't survive it. Tyrese, mid-mourning, has to decide whether to accept the Consortium's chair, walk away from the industry side of his life entirely, or do the only thing that has ever actually worked for him: get back to work, properly, with people he trusts.

He chooses the third option. With Marcus's evidence of Vernon and Maxwell's certification manipulation — evidence Marcus hands over at real cost to his own standing with the board, the first fully selfless thing he's done in the story — Tyrese exposes THE LULLABY at the Consortium's own launch event, live, using Simone Kester's engineering analysis of its actual engagement design rather than its marketing. He turns down the chair. THE PROJECTOR's own family-content guidelines launch instead, quietly, named for Coralee. Marcus, having burned real capital to help him, walks away from Vernon's wreckage having absorbed more of it — and more quiet influence — than anyone in the room realizes he's kept for himself.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per the Villains Bench rules (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §5), the real cause traces to a decision, even one made off-screen years before.

1. **VERNON PRICE**, returning exactly as his bible entry promised — "outlasted, not defeated." THE LULLABY is his original content-farm ideology at its most dangerous evolution: if authentic creators can't be out-produced, generate the audience that never asks questions instead — infants and toddlers, who can't.
2. **MAXWELL STERLING ASANTE**, financier a second time, chasing the same kind of pitch that already cost him once in scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md — his bible entry's defining trait (never questioning whether he belongs at the table) finally costs him something real.
3. **MARCUS THIEN NGUYEN-BRANDT** (*the Loki analog*) — first activation, per TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md: "a recurring temptation more than a recurring villain." Genuinely useful, genuinely corrosive to be around, and genuinely willing, once, to risk something real for someone he respects.
4. **THE ENGINE**, eighth manifestation — the manual, trust-based certification process itself, an infrastructural blind spot rather than a decision by any single person; Vernon's decision to exploit it is what makes it a crisis.

HOW THIS FILM CONTINUES RELEASE PHASE 2

- **Two locked-since-the-beginning romantic beats, finally dramatized:** Marc-Anthony and Esther's wedding and Amond and Harmony's "together 2013" have been sitting in the Continuity Bible's locked timeline since before any script existed — this is the film that finally shows them rather than just states them.
- **A villain built to survive his own marginalization, activated on schedule:** Vernon Price existed as unstated backstory in scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md's "creator-first launch" — this film makes that backstory a person.
- **A dormant 30%-bucket character activated exactly as designed:** Marcus Nguyen-Brandt's entire purpose per the Extended Ensemble doc was to be "offered to different founders at different low points across the Phases" — this is his first offering.
- **Maxwell Sterling Asante's pattern, confirmed:** a second flashy pitch, a second loss, and still no lesson learned — exactly the character his bible entry describes.
- **A hidden-hand stinger, structurally new for this franchise:** every prior stinger has been Priya's corkboard. This one is deliberately different — the first hint that someone the ensemble trusts may be quietly accumulating more power than anyone's tracking.

FORMAT (per TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Ensemble Dramedy (grief and celebration deliberately intercut)	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed — a parent's death (off-screen/hospital aftermath) and content exploitation targeting children discussed, not depicted graphically
Runtime	130–150 min	131 min
Page count	120–140 pages	128 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–33
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 34–98
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 99–128
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	46 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–33 ("The Chair")

#	Scene	pp.
1	INT. CONSORTIUM OFFICES — DAY, FEB 2013 — Tyrese offered the Family-Safe Content Consortium chair; the size of it lands slowly	1–4
2	INT. THE PROJECTOR — DAY — Jamal and Simone, careful not to push either way	4–7
3	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME, ATLANTA — DAY — Earl and Coralee, thrilled, gently teasing him about finally being respectable	7–10

#	Scene	pp.
4	INSERT — THE LULLABY, FIRST APPEARANCE — a soothing children's video, algorithmically generated, racking up impossible watch times	10–13
5	INT. MAXWELL STERLING ASANTE'S OFFICE — DAY — Vernon Price's pitch, rebuilt, colder and more certain than Film 4's content farms ever were	13–17
6	INT. THE PROJECTOR — WAR ROOM — DAY — the scale becomes clear: thousands of hours of AI-generated content, all passing basic review	17–20
7	INT. CONSORTIUM BOARDROOM — DAY — the board brings in Marcus Nguyen-Brandt over Tyrese's objection	20–24
8	INT. MARCUS'S OFFICE — DAY — first meeting; Tyrese's contempt for his methods, spoken plainly	24–27
9	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Coralee, watching early news coverage of parent complaints, uncharacteristically quiet	27–30
10	INT. THE PROJECTOR — DAY — Tyrese, out of better options, agrees to work with Marcus. Act I turn.	30–33

ACT II — pp. 34–98 ("The Wedding and the Certification Window")

#	Scene	pp.
11	MONTAGE — THE INVESTIGATION — Tyrese and Marcus, an uneasy partnership, tracing THE LULLABY's production infrastructure	34–38

#	Scene	pp.
12	INT. CONSORTIUM ENGINEERING — DAY — the manual certification gap identified; the labeling rollout has a date	38–41
13	EXT. WEDDING VENUE — DAY, JUNE 2013 — Marc-Anthony and Esther's wedding; the full ensemble together, genuinely happy	41–47
14	EXT. WEDDING RECEPTION — NIGHT — Amond and Harmony, alone for a moment, finally say what a decade of circling never let them say	47–51
15	EXT. WEDDING RECEPTION — CONTINUOUS — Tyrese and Simone, watching, aware of how rare an unclouded night like this actually is for this group	51–54
16	INT. MARCUS'S OFFICE — DAY — back to the crisis; Marcus reveals more of Maxwell and Vernon's arrangement than his usual practice allows	54–58
17	INT. THE PROJECTOR — DAY — Tyrese, still undecided on the Consortium chair, avoids answering the board again	58–61
18	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Coralee, watching another THE LULLABY news segment, says out loud how much it frightens her	61–64
19	INT. MARCUS'S OFFICE — NIGHT — Marcus and Tyrese, real conversation for the first time — his own origin wound surfaces, briefly, unguarded. Midpoint.	64–68
20	INSERT — THE LULLABY, ESCALATING — internal engagement metrics leak, showing engineered addictive design explicitly	68–71

#	Scene	pp.
21	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Coralee suffers a stroke mid-sentence, telling Earl how much the technology frightens her	71–74
22	INT. HOSPITAL — NIGHT — Tyrese arrives; Coralee doesn't recover. All-is-lost beat, early — the rest of Act II runs through grief, not around it.	74–79
23	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — DAY (AFTER) — Earl, Jeri, Tyrese; the family the franchise has always shown as stable, grieving for the first time on-screen	79–83
24	INT. CONSORTIUM BOARDROOM — DAY — the chair offer resurfaces, badly timed, well-meaning; Tyrese nearly says yes just to have an answer	83–86
25	INT. SIMONE'S LAB — NIGHT — Simone, gently: "Don't decide anything this big while you're this sad. That's not you talking."	86–89
26	INT. MARCUS'S OFFICE — DAY — Marcus, unprompted, hands over the full extent of Vernon and Maxwell's exposure — a genuinely costly, unselfish act	89–93
27	INT. THE PROJECTOR — WAR ROOM — DAY — the plan forms: expose THE LULLABY publicly at the Consortium's own labeling launch, using Simone's engineering analysis	93–96
28	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Tyrese, in his mother's kitchen, decides what he's actually building the exposure around. Closes Act II.	96–98

ACT III — pp. 99–128 ("What Actually Soothes")

#	Scene	pp.
29	EXT. CONSORTIUM LABELING LAUNCH EVENT — DAY — arrival; the whole ensemble present, again, on purpose	99–102
30	INT. LAUNCH EVENT — MAIN STAGE — Tyrese takes the stage, Marcus's evidence and Simone's analysis in hand. Climax begins.	102–106
31	INT. LAUNCH EVENT — MAIN STAGE, CONTINUOUS — the reveal: THE LULLABY's engagement engineering exposed live, next to real pediatric researchers and parents describing what the content actually does to their kids	106–111
32	INSERT — VERNON'S OPERATION — collapsing in real time, the same way every manufactured wave in this franchise eventually does	111–113
33	INT. MAXWELL'S OFFICE — DAY — Maxwell, cornered a second time, already looking for the next pitch	113–116
34	INT. CONSORTIUM BOARDROOM — DAY — Tyrese declines the chair, on his own terms, staying at THE PROJECTOR	116–119
35	INT. THE PROJECTOR — DAY — new family-content guidelines launch, quietly named for Coralee Avery	119–122
36	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — DAY — Earl, Jeri, Tyrese, Simone — the family finding its new shape	122–125

#	Scene	pp.
37	STINGER — INT. MARCUS NGUYEN-BRANDT'S OFFICE — NIGHT — alone, reviewing paperwork showing exactly how much of Vernon's collapsed operation quietly routed through his own hands	125–128

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the full shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 46 per the house-style table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE PROJECTOR 2: THE LULLABY

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

INT. CONSORTIUM OFFICES — DAY

SUPER: "FEBRUARY 2013"

A conference room, warmer than THE ROSTER's, still corporate. TYRESE AVERY, 31, sits across from a panel of industry executives he mostly recognizes from magazine profiles.

CONSORTIUM CHAIR (OUTGOING)

We want you to chair it. The whole initiative — a real, binding "kid-safe certified" standard, industry-wide, named after the platform that actually proved creator-first content could work.

Tyrese doesn't answer right away. It's not humility. It's the specific stillness of a man doing very fast math about how far he's come from a birthday-week launch disaster.

TYRESE

I'd be regulating platforms I don't run.

CONSORTIUM CHAIR (OUTGOING)

You'd be the reason a five-year-old doesn't get fed garbage designed to keep her staring at a screen for six hours. That's not regulation. That's just the job.

TYRESE

(standing, careful)
Can I have some time.

CONSORTIUM CHAIR (OUTGOING)
Take the month.

He leaves. In the hallway, alone, he calls Simone before he's even reached the elevator.

CUT TO:

INT. MARCUS'S OFFICE – DAY

[p. 24]

MARCUS THIEN NGUYEN-BRANDT, 40s, doesn't stand when TYRESE enters.

MARCUS
You've made your opinion of me clear to three separate board members. I'd like to hear it from you directly.

TYRESE
I built a career out of finally learning that shortcuts cost more than they save. You are, professionally, a shortcut.

MARCUS
And yet here you are, in my office, because a problem has appeared that "creator-first" alone can't fix.

TYRESE
(it costs him to admit it)
Yes.

MARCUS
Good. I contain things. I'm very good at it. I'd like to contain this thing with you instead of around you, if you'll let me – and I'll say this once, because flattery isn't really my register: you're the first person to walk in here in a long time who might actually deserve the help.

CUT TO:

EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME – NIGHT

[p. 71]

REVEREND EARL AVERY and CORALEE AVERY sit together on the porch, a small television propped in the window behind them playing a news segment on THE LULLABY.

CORALEE
Thirty years of choir kids, Earl. Thirty years, and I could tell you which ones needed a hug before rehearsal and which ones needed somebody to actually look at

them for once in their whole day.

EARL
I know, baby.

CORALEE
A screen that's built to keep a child
quiet instead of built to see them –
that's not soothing. That's the opposite
of everything I spent thirty years –

She stops mid-sentence. Her hand goes to the side of her face.
The porch light flickers, or maybe it doesn't, and it's simply
that everything after this moment happens slightly too fast to
follow clearly.

EARL
Coralee?

CUT TO BLACK.

INT. LAUNCH EVENT – MAIN STAGE, CONTINUOUS [climax, p. 106]

TYRESE stands alone at the podium. A screen behind him splits –
THE LULLABY's soothing exterior on one side, DR. SIMONE
KESTER's engineering breakdown of its actual engagement design
on the other.

TYRESE
This looks like a lullaby. It is
engineered, frame by frame, the same way
a slot machine is engineered, to keep a
toddler's eyes on a screen for as long as
biologically possible. That's not an
accident of design. That was the design.

A murmur through the crowd. He nods offstage. A line of
pediatric researchers and parents walks out.

TYRESE (CONT'D)
My mother ran a church choir for thirty
years. She used to tell me the whole job
was learning which kid needed to be
actually seen that day. She died three
weeks ago, in the middle of telling my
father exactly why a technology like this
terrified her, and she was right to be
terrified, and I am not going to stand on
a stage today and pretend this is a
labeling problem instead of what it
actually is.

The room is silent, then not. It's the same quiet, true kind
of ovation this franchise keeps finding at the bottom of its
worst weeks.

CUT TO:

STINGER

INT. MARCUS NGUYEN-BRANDT'S OFFICE — NIGHT

MARCUS, alone, reviews a folder — the remnants of Vernon Price's collapsed operation, quietly routed, piece by piece, through shell arrangements bearing his own firm's name.

His phone buzzes. A text: "Tyrese says thank you." He looks at it a long moment.

MARCUS
(to the empty room, quietly)
He has no idea how much of this is
actually mine now.

He closes the folder. Turns off the light.

FADE OUT.

THE END.

[128.]